I. Plants are nature's gift

A plant has many parts. Each part has a set of function to do.

The basic parts of a plant are root, stem, leaf, flower, fruit and seed.

Let us learn about various parts of the plant, their structure and function.

Root

The root is a part of the plant that usually grows under the soil. Roots can be of different shapes and sizes. It grows away from sunlight into the soil. They are of two main types: tap root and fibrous root.

Taproot

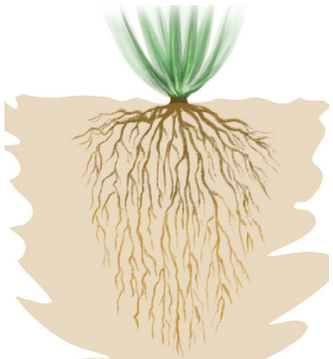


Taproot

Taproot has one main, thick root. It grows from the radicle and goes deep into the soil. Many small thin roots grow out from the main root. Plants such as **carrot, beetroot, turnip, mango and neem** have taproots.

Fibrous Root

A fibrous root consists of many thin roots of different sizes. They grow from the base of the stem and all of them are bunched together. They do not go deep into the soil. Plants such as **grass, paddy, wheat and onion** have fibrous roots.



Fibrous Root

Functions of Root

Fixation: Root fixes the plant firmly to the soil. Without the roots, a plant would fall on the ground.

Absorption: Roots absorb water and minerals required for the plant from the soil.

Storage of food: In some plants, roots store food. **E.g.,** Carrot, Radish, Beetroot.

Difference between taproot and fibrous root

Taproot	Fibrous root
Thick main root that goes deep into the soil.	No main root and the roots do not go deep into the soil.
Side roots are developed from the main root.	Roots are developed from the base of the stem.
Looks like a long tap E.g., Tamarind, Guava.	Looks like a bunch. E.g., Corn, Sugarcane.

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